

needs. System maintenance and safety is the responsibility of the service provider. The service may be onsite or at a remote location depending on needs. This type of service is used more for HPC on cloud which requires data storage as well as active computing and includes leasing computing hardware rather than purchasing it. HaaS is at times similar to IaaS, though IaaS is more of a complete service.



Platform as a Service

(PaaS): This kind of service involves the provision

of a computing platform which includes an operating system, server side scripting environment, program execution environment, database management and web server. Additional tools for hosting, storage, design and development might also be provided. A PaaS typically allows the user to build software with the use of tools provided by the service. This allows developers to concentrate on program and code development rather than underlying software and hardware. PaaS also offers a flexible development platform that can be adopted by experts and beginners alike. Another advantage users have is that they can communicate with co-developers in different parts of the world on the same code build. PaaS essentially provides an optimal development environment for making web based applications with seamless integration of a coding environment, database handling, storage and security. Examples of PaaS are Google App Engine, Windows Azure Cloud Services and Openshift.

Software as a Service (SaaS): This one should be a no brainer. SaaS is simply providing any form of software or application as service. Service includes basic infrastructure and platforms need to run the software. Basically a client can access an application on the cloud using just the internet. This eliminates the need to install software on the user's local device. Using a combination of load balancers, virtualisation and multi-tenant concepts, multiple users can use the software simultaneously, and boost productivity. A SaaS encourages a subscription model rather than a purchasing model. Clients need not handle the purchase of licenses for each software they need, they simply subscribe to a number of users they need concurrently working on the software on the cloud. Apart from lower hardware and software costs, this also makes operations scalable. The only drawback is